

Subject Code	ENGL5020
Subject Title	Task-Based Language Teaching
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite/ Co-requisite/ Exclusion	N/A
Objectives	This course aims to achieve the following objectives: • enhance students' understanding of task-based language learning and teaching by providing opportunities to read and critique existing research, reflect on their own teaching and learning experience; • examine the pedagogical proposals for a task-based approach to second language teaching; and • hone students' ability to apply research findings to classroom teaching by engaging in activities of task development, task implementation, and task evaluation.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a. evaluate the extent to which a pedagogical activity meets the criteria of tasks; b. understand the theories and research findings on task-based instruction and learning; c. design pedagogical tasks following the principles of a task-based approach and incorporating research findings; and d. make informed decisions in language teaching.
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	This subject provides an overview of the theory, research, and practice of task-based language teaching. The subject covers the following topics. • Theories of task-based language teaching • Task criteria • Task complexity • Focus on form • Individual differences and task-based teaching • Task-based assessment
Teaching/Learning Methodology	Teaching and learning will take the form of themed lectures followed by interactive seminars.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed			
			a	b	c	d
	1. Lesson evaluation	40%	✓	✓		
	2. Lesson development	50%		✓		✓
	3. Participation	10%	✓	✓	✓	✓
	Total	100%				
The lesson evaluation assignment requires students to apply task-based research findings to evaluate existing language classes. The lesson development assignment provides an opportunity for students to develop a task-based lesson based on empirical evidence and best practices. This assignment requires an oral presentation of the lesson plan and a written report of the lesson plan. The participation component encourages students to fully engage in the course.						
Student Study Effort Expected	Class contact:					
	▪ Lectures					39 Hrs.
	▪ Seminars					0 Hrs.
	Other student study effort:					
	▪ Private study					45 Hrs.
	▪ Assignments					28 Hrs.
	Total student study effort					112 Hrs.
Reading List and References	<u>Required Textbook</u>					
	Ellis, R., Skehan, P., Li, S., Shintani, N., & Lambert, C. (2020). <i>Task-based language teaching: Theory and practice</i> . Cambridge University Press.					
	<u>Recommended Readings</u>					
	Kim, Y. (2013). Effects of pretask modelling on attention to form and question development. <i>TESOL Quarterly</i> , 47, 8-35. Li, S. (Ed.) (2024). <i>Individual differences and task-based language teaching</i> . John Benjamins.					

	Li, S., & Fu, M. (2017). Strategic and unpressured within-task planning and their associations with working memory. <i>Language Teaching Research</i>, 22, 230-253. Long, M. (2015). <i>Second language acquisition and task-based language teaching</i>. Wiley Blackwell. Révész, A. (2009). Task complexity, focus on form, and second language development. <i>Studies in Second Language Acquisition</i>, 31, 437-470. Robinson, P. (Ed.) (2011). <i>Second language task complexity: Researching the Cognition Hypothesis of language learning and performance</i>. John Benjamins. Skehan, P. (Ed.) (2014). <i>Processing perspectives on task performance</i>. John Benjamins. Thai, C., & Boers, F. (2015). Repeating a monologue under increasing time pressure: Effects on fluency, complexity, and accuracy. <i>TESOL Quarterly</i>, 50, 369-393.
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Revised by Prof. Shaofeng Li as of Jan 2026